

POND TURTLES

These turtles range from being fully aquatic to fully terrestrial. Most of them are found in North America, but one species in this family comes from Europe. Diet varies between species, although many are herbivores. The Emydidae are often brightly coloured and intricately marked.



28 cm
11 in

RED-EARED SLIDER
Trachemys scripta elegans

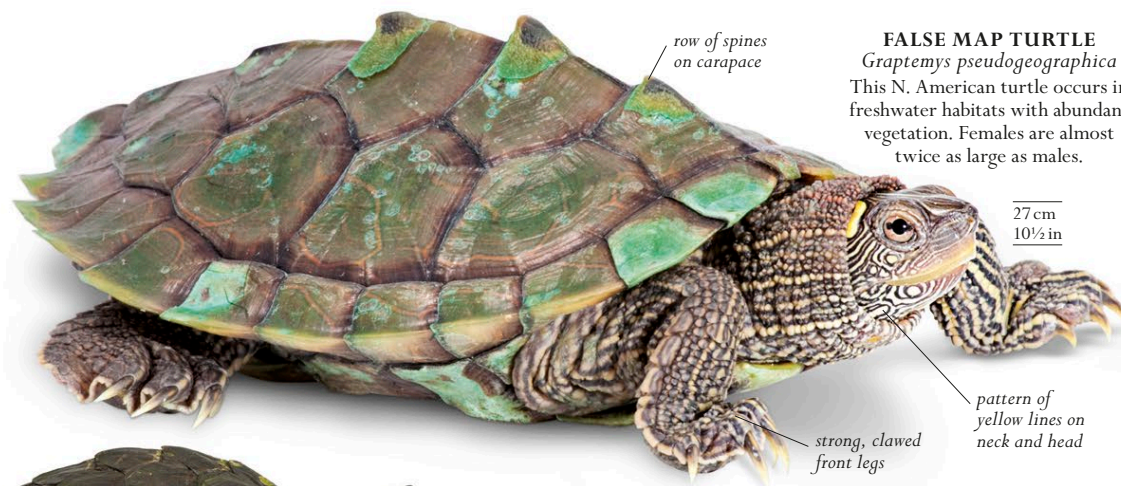
This N. American species is mainly herbivorous and is common in the pet trade. Its ability to colonize new habitats has allowed it to become widely established in Europe and Asia.



27 cm
10½ in

YELLOW SLIDER
Trachemys scripta scripta

Named for its habit of sliding into water when disturbed, this turtle of the S. USA is a diurnal omnivore.



row of spines
on carapace

27 cm
10½ in

FALSE MAP TURTLE
Graptemys pseudogeographica
This N. American turtle occurs in freshwater habitats with abundant vegetation. Females are almost twice as large as males.

pattern of
yellow lines on
neck and head

strong, clawed
front legs



23 cm
9 in

DIAMONDBACK TERRAPIN
Malaclemys terrapin

This is a diurnal species of brackish waters in eastern N. America. It has powerful jaws adapted for eating crustaceans and molluscs.



25 cm
10 in

PAINTED TURTLE
Chrysemys picta

Widely distributed in N. America, this small, freshwater turtle is active during summer. During winter, it lies torpid under water.



20 cm
8 in

CAROLINA BOX TURTLE
Terrapene carolina

Males of this N. American species have evolved highly curved claws that help grip the female's domed shell while mating.



14 cm
5½ in

ORNATE BOX TURTLE
Terrapene ornata

This is an omnivorous, terrestrial turtle of central N. America. It digs burrows to escape extreme heat or cold.

strong claws used
for burrowing



13 cm
5 in

SPOTTED TURTLE
Clemmys guttata

Identifiable by its spots, this small turtle feeds on aquatic invertebrates and plants in the marshes of eastern N. America.



26 cm
10 in

CHICKEN TURTLE
Deirochelys reticularia

This shy turtle of swamps in eastern N. America extends its long neck to strike at crayfish and other prey.



21 cm
8½ in

EUROPEAN POND TURTLE
Emys orbicularis

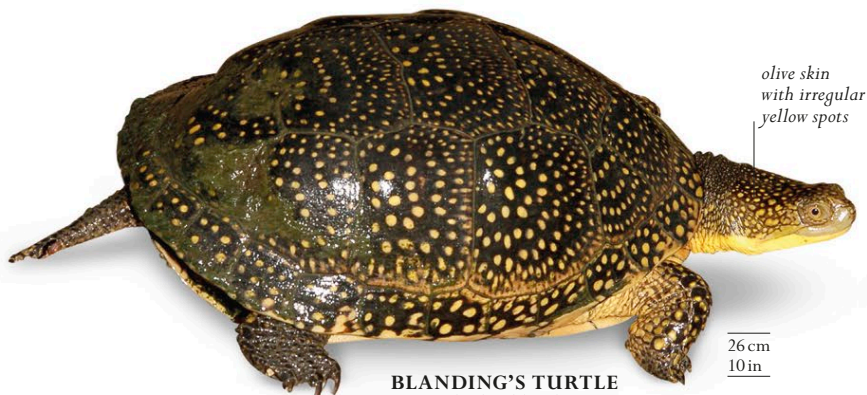
Widespread in Europe, this is a highly aquatic turtle. It basks on logs or rocks, but rapidly dives into the water if disturbed.



13 cm
5 in

WOOD TURTLE
Glyptemys insculpta

This turtle occupies the damp forests in northeastern N. America. Unusually, males and females perform an elegant dance together during courtship.



olive skin
with irregular
yellow spots

26 cm
10 in

BLANDING'S TURTLE
Emydoidea blandingii

Found mainly across the Great Lakes region of N. America, this turtle is an omnivore and especially skilled at capturing crayfish.



38 cm
15 in

FLORIDA REDBELLY TURTLE
Pseudemys nelsoni

Restricted to Florida, this turtle lives in lakes and slow-moving streams. During courtship, the male caresses the female's head with his forelimbs.



40 cm
16 in

RED-BELLIED TURTLE
Pseudemys rubriventris

Restricted to the N.E. USA, this omnivorous, diurnal species prefers large, deep bodies of water. Females are larger than males.